The Wolf Who Cried Boy

By Bob Hartman

NARRATOR: Once upon a time there lived a family of wolves. They stole sheep, ran after rabbits and dined on ducklings and deer. Except for Little Wolf, that is, who never stopped complaining about what his mother prepared each night for dinner.

LITTLE WOLF: *(whining)* Lamburgers again! I hate Lamburgers! *(howling)* Minced mole-roles? We had minced mole-roles last night! *(whimpering)* Chocolate moose? Chocolate moose makes me sick! And besides, it looks just like . . .

FATHER WOLF: *(barking)* That's enough!

INTRODUCTION

Poop . . . it looks like fluffy poop! . . . You really can't blame the little guy! Gross!

But that's beside the point. You've all heard the story of The Boy Who Cried Wolf . . . today I'm here to flip that story on its head. This is the story of . . . . The Wolf Who Cried Boy by Bob Hartman

LITTLE WOLF: Boy! Why can't we have boy tonight? We never have boy anymore!

FATHER WOLF: *(sighing)* Well, son, there was a time when a clever wolf could snatch a shepherd boy off a hill or pluck a farm boy out of a field. Why, there was nothing better than a steaming plate of "boy" chops, *(Mmmm)* a big baked boy-tato *(Mmmm)* and some "Boys-N-Berry" pie *(Mmmmm).* But boys are hard to come by these days, in fact, they're rare. So stop your complaining and finish off that moose.

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LITTLE WOLF: *(muttering)* Yes, father. But suppose . . . suppose I did find a boy someday?

FATHER WOLF: *(smiling)* You find a boy out there in the woods and your mother and I would be happy catch him and cook him for you. But I wouldn't get my hopes up if I were you. Like I said, boys are rare.

NARRATOR: So, the next day as Little Wolf made his way home from school, he sniffed the air. *(Sniff)* Three pig salad? *(moaning)* I hate three pig salad! And then Little Wolf remembered what his father had told him about catching a boy some day. So he decided to play a little trick and he put off that awful dinner for a while. He ran home just as fast as he could, howling all the way.

LITTLE WOLF: *(howling)* Boy! Boy! I've just seen a boy in the woods! If we hurry, we can catch him!

NARRATOR: Father and Mother Wolf raced out of the cave. They ran through the woods to the top of the hill and all the way down to the creek. They peered into trees and sniffed behind rocks and looked into every hollow log. But they could not find the boy.

FATHER WOLF: *(panting)* We looked everywhere – everywhere a boy might go, but we just couldn't find him. Better luck next time, son.

NARRATOR: Little Wolf tried to look disappointed, but it was all he could do to keep from laughing. The joke got even better when his mother announced:

MOTHER WOLF: Oh, no. The three pig salad is ruined. The bricks are limp. The straw is damp and the sticks have all turned, well . . . "sticky."

FATHER WOLF: Don't worry, dear. We can make due with snack food tonight.

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NARRATOR: And so they crunched on chipmunks and dip and Little Wolf was happy. So happy, in fact, that he decided to try the same trick the very next day.

LITTLE WOLF: It's the boy! I saw him again. He's just at the edge of the woods!

NARRATOR: So once again Father and Mother Wolf went racing after the boy. Once again, they came dragging home, their paws empty and once again, their dinner was ruined.

MOTHER WOLF: *(sighing)* Just look at that Granny Smith Pie. The apples are entirely too mushy.

FATHER WOLF: Yup. And Granny's gone all crusty and hard.

LITTLE WOLF: *(shrugging)* Looks like snacks again tonight!

NARRATOR: But the smile on his face made Father Wolf wonder. And then he heard his son a little later on the phone.

LITTLE WOLF: *(whispering)* That's right. I didn't have to eat dinner tonight either. I think I'll tell them there's a boy out there tomorrow too!

NARRATOR: Father Wolf upon hearing this went straight to Mother Wolf and they agreed that on the following night they would ignore his silly tricks. So . . . the next day Little Wolf made his way from home from school as usual. He could smell the awful odor of the steaming musk-ratatouille as it floated out of the cave. And he was just about to holler "boy" when the most amazing thing happened. There walking through the woods before him were more boys . . . more boys than he had ever seen. A Boy Scout troup!

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LITTLE WOLF: *(howling)* Boy! B-b-b-boys!

NARRATOR: But no one came running from the cave.

LITTLE WOLF: *(howling)* Boys! B-b-boys!

NARRATOR: But still no one came, so he ran into the cave shouting:

LITTLE WOLF: There are boys out there! Mom! Dad! Dozens of them. Big ones and little ones; fat ones and skinny ones. Enough to fill our freezer! And Auntie's freezer too!

NARRATOR: But his mother just shrugged and said:

MOTHER WOLF: That's very nice, dear. But I already have our supper planned.

NARRATOR: Father Wolf hid his face behind the newspaper. And that's when one of the boys stuck his head – he actually stuck his head – in the cave. He was the mischievous type. A lot like Little Wolf, in fact. And he'd crept away from his scout pack to have a closer look.

LITTLE WOLF: *(shouting)* See! There's one of them now!

NARRATOR: But even though the boy tip-toed right into the cave. Little Wolf couldn't get anyone to look.

LITTLE WOLF: *(howling)* There's a boy on the couch! C- c- c- couch!

MOTHER WOLF: That's enough now, son.

FATHER WOLF: You're not fooling us again! We're onto your little tricks.

LITTLE WOLF: *(pleading)* But I'm not lying this time. Honest! There really is a boy! Right here in our cave!

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NARRATOR: The boy glanced at his watch and then turned to leave.

BOY: *[put hands to ears, wiggle fingers, stick out tongue and give Little Wolf a raspberry (Pbbbttttttt).]*

LITTLE WOLF: *(begging)* Please, look! Look! He's getting away!

NARRATOR: By the time Father Wolf finally stuck his head above the paper, the boy was gone.

LITTLE WOLF: *(crying)* You waited too long! He was here a minute ago. All we have to do is run outside. But you won't.

FATHER WOLF: *(growling)* We will do no such thing! From now on you'll eat your dinner without complaining.

MOTHER WOLF: And you will stop fibbing, once and for all. Do you understand, Little Wolf?

LITTLE WOLF: *(sighing)* Yes.

NARRATOR: So from then on, Little Wolf ate lamburgers and three pig salad and he even grew fond of Granny Smith pie. And he never, ever, cried "boy" again. And that's why the boys, at least, lived happily ever after.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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